

KURUKSHETRA: A LIFE · 29 OCTOBER 2026

Art brief annex: the playtest changes

An annex to the main brief (*Pictures Required*), for the changes collected from the 29 October playtest (PRD §18.11). Every one of those changes can be built with the paintings the game already has, so **nothing here holds up the work**. These pictures make the new moments look as intended instead of borrowing a painting made for something else.

Group	What	Images	Priority
A	Inside the Chakravyuha (the last stand beside Abhimanyu), tall and wide	**2**	Recommended
B	Portraits of the two commanders who test you: Bhishma and Dhrishtadyumna	**2**	Recommended
C	The armoury, where you choose your weapon	**1**	Recommended
D	Test stages: the muster field, Drona's gate, the road behind the lines (tall and wide)	**6**	Optional
Total		**11**	

Until these arrive, the game uses: the war-field fight background for the last stand, the existing speaker cards for the commanders, Drona's training ground for the armoury and the audition, the top-down field of the wheel test for the formation test, and the fair's race track for the chariot run.

RULES

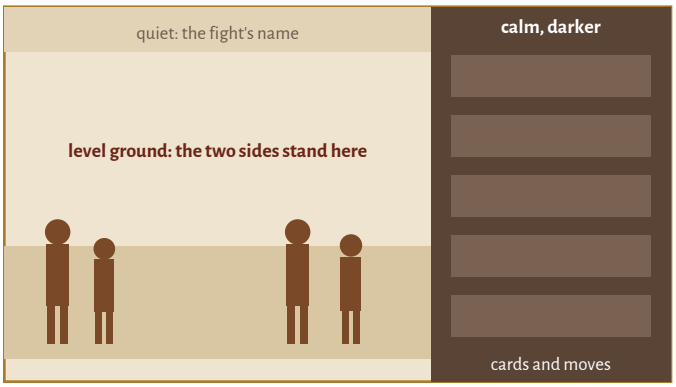
Rules for this annex

Everything in the main brief applies: the game's warm, painterly early-historic India; no painted text; timber, brick and stone (no domes, tall temple spires or castle towers); violence implied, no blood; made or licensed for this project, AI use noted. Specific to these pictures:

- **Abhimanyu's last stand without gore.** Show the ring of chariots, dust, broken weapons and a fallen wheel; never a body or a wound. The player and Abhimanyu are drawn by the game as puppets, so the fight background has no figures in its centre.
- **Canon portraits** (Bhishma, Dhrishtadyumna) need advisory review before public use, like the other portraits. Bhishma: very old, white beard, upright, white garments, a palm-tree banner motif. Dhrishtadyumna: a young prince of Panchala, born from the fire altar in the epic; a faint warm light, not flames on his body.
- **Fight backgrounds** keep level ground in the band shown in the layouts (the puppets stand on it), and a calmer, darker area where the cards and moves sit. Please state the height of the ground line on delivery; the game now places the puppets' feet on it.

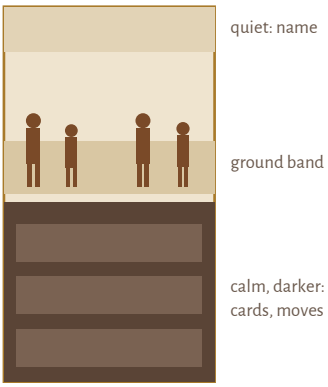
Layouts

B. 16:9 fight background (2560×1440)



laptops, desktops, tablets held sideways

C. 9:16 fight (1080×1920)



phones

Kind	Size	Notes
Fight, tall	1080×1920 (9:16)	Phones. Layout C above.
Fight, wide	2560×1440 (16:9)	Laptops and desktops. Layout B above.
Portrait	480×640 (3:4)	Head and shoulders, matching p_drona and p_kripa: plain warm background, lit from one side.
Scene	2560×1440 (16:9)	The game cuts its 3:1 banner from the middle band: subject in the centre 40% of the width and the middle third of the height; calm lower half.
Test stage	tall 1080×1920; wide 2560×1440 (top-down) or 2560×720 (course)	Top-down stages: open ground in the middle. Course stages tile top to bottom (tall) or left to right (wide).

GROUP A · 2 IMAGES · RECOMMENDED

Inside the Chakravyuha

One fight background in two shapes. It replaces the open war field for the last stand beside Abhimanyu.



fight_chakravyuha_inner_tall · fight_chakravyuha_inner

Fight background · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: The last stand inside the wheel on the thirteenth day: the player beside Abhimanyu against Drona, Karna, Kripa and Ashwatthama (PRD §18.11 C2). Also the Kaurava side of the same fight. Today it borrows the open war field.

Paint: Inside the Chakravyuha at late afternoon: a closed ring of chariots and banners on every side, wheels locked, bows raised along the rim; dust hanging gold in low sun; the ground inside trampled, with broken arrows, a snapped bow and one fallen chariot wheel lying flat. Level open ground in the centre for the puppets; the ring higher and darker toward the top. The feeling: no way out. No figures in the centre, no bodies, no blood.

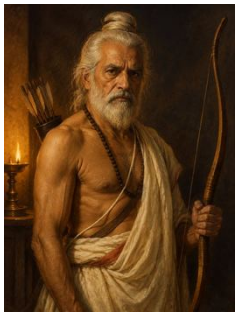
Note: Match the light and banners of scene_day13. The wide version leaves the right third calmer and darker for the cards (layout B).

Match: scene_day13_wide

GROUP B · 2 IMAGES · RECOMMENDED

The commanders

Two portraits for the commanders who test a player before giving them a company.



p_bhishma

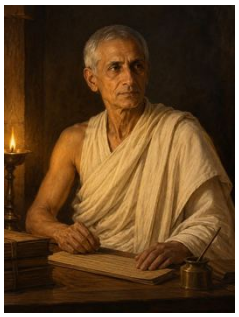
Portrait · 480×640

Used for: Speaker card when Bhishma, commanding the Kaurava army, tests a player who asks for a company ("Set the formation", PRD §18.11 C1); also his bed of arrows and the war's first days.

Paint: Bhishma, the grandsire: very old, long white beard and hair, a lean upright warrior's frame, white garments and a simple gold armband, a bow-string callus on the hand at most; eyes calm and tired. A small palm-tree emblem on a clasp. Warm plain background.

Note: Advisory review. Match p_drona and p_kripa in framing and light.

Match: p_drona



p_dhrishtadyumna

Portrait · 480×640

Used for: Speaker card when Dhrishtadyumna, commander of the Pandava army, tests a player who asks for a company (PRD §18.11 C1).

Paint: Dhrishtadyumna, Draupadi's twin brother, prince of Panchala and commander of the Pandava host: about thirty, strong and alert, dark hair tied up, light armour over red and ochre, a commander's conch at his belt; a faint warm glow behind him (born from the fire altar), no flames on his body.

Note: Advisory review. Same framing and light as the other portraits.

Match: p_kripa

GROUP C · 1 IMAGE · RECOMMENDED

The armoury

One scene for choosing a weapon.



scene_armoury

Scene · 2560×1440

Used for: Choosing your weapon: the teacher lays out bow, mace, sword, chariot reins and staff, and you pick one before its test (PRD §18.11 D3).

Paint: The weapons room of the teacher's school in early morning: timber pillars and a beaten-earth floor, light through a lattice; on a low wooden rack and a reed mat, laid out side by side, a long bamboo bow and quiver, a bronze-headed mace, a straight sword in its scabbard, a coiled set of chariot reins with a whip, and a long staff. Room for the eye to travel along them. The teacher only as a shadow at the doorway.

Note: Each of the five weapons must read clearly at phone size; the game may highlight them one by one.

Match: scene_teacher_wide

GROUP D · 6 IMAGES · OPTIONAL

Test stages

Three places, each tall and wide, so these tests stop borrowing paintings made for other tests.



stage_muster_field_top_tall · stage_muster_field_top

Test stage · top-down · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: "Set the formation": placing archers, chariots, spearmen and elephants on their marks before the drums stop (PRD §18.11 C1). Today it shares the wheel test's painting.

Paint: Seen from above at dawn: a wide, flat muster ground behind the army's camp, pale grass worn to earth, faint chalk lines and small marker flags in a loose grid, the commander's chariot and a drum stand at one edge, tents along the far edge. Large open middle where the game places the units. No soldiers painted in the middle.

Match: stage_chakravyuha_top



stage_drona_gate_tall · stage_drona_gate

Test stage · scene · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: The outsider's audition: a very hard archery shot at Drona's gate, before he will take a student not of the court (PRD §18.11 D2). Today it borrows Drona's training ground.

Paint: Outside the gate of Drona's school at dusk: a timber gateway and fence, the training ground glimpsed beyond; across a stream, a tall lone tree far away with a small wooden bird target on its highest branch, barely visible; long shadows. Open ground in the foreground where the archer stands.

Match: stage_training_ground



stage_war_road_tall · stage_war_road

Test stage · course · 1080×1920 (tiles top to bottom); 2560×720 (tiles left to right)

Used for: The chariot driver's run on the eve of the war, before a warrior accepts you as driver (PRD §18.11 C4, if approved). Today it borrows the spring fair's race track.

Paint: The rutted road behind the battle lines, by day: supply carts, tethered horses, stacks of spears and arrows, a fallen tent pole and a broken wheel as obstacles, dust; the war's banners far off at one side. A clear track down the middle that must tile seamlessly.

Match: stage_racetrack

ALSO

What needs no paintings

- **Divine weapons in a fight** (PRD §18.11 C3): the darkening, the mantra's light, fire, rain, wind, haze, the serpent coil and the clash in mid-air are drawn by the game over the battle painting. The emblems for each weapon are already in the divine weapons brief.
- **The stealth guard** with his torch and beam, **the archery aim** and placement, and the **puppets' feet on the ground**: drawn by the game.
- **Ugra's wrestling bout** uses the existing **fight_fair_ring**; the **lac house** opens on the existing calm painting; **the map** and **the moves list** are code; the death in the wheel uses the existing **end_wheel**.

For art already ordered

The 12 wide fight backgrounds in the main brief (priority 2) should follow the same ground rule: level ground in the marked band, and the height of the ground line stated on delivery.

Delivery and checklist

- Name every file exactly as listed (portraits and scenes as .jpg; fights and stages as _tall.jpg and .jpg).
- One zip for groups A to C, a second for group D; partial batches are fine. Upload to art_review/ in the GitHub repo, or attach in the chat.
- Render at native size wherever your tool allows. Note which pieces are AI-generated and which tool made them.

- ☐ Fights: tall 1080×1920 and wide 2560×1440; open level ground for the puppets, no figures in the centre; ground line height stated
- ☐ Portraits 480×640, framed and lit like p_drona and p_kripa
- ☐ Scene 2560×1440 with the subject in the centre band; all five weapons readable at phone size
- ☐ Stages: tall 1080×1920; wide 2560×1440 (top-down) or 2560×720 (course); course stages tile seamlessly
- ☐ No blood, bodies or wounds; no divine figures; no text, signatures or watermarks
- ☐ Period details right: no domes, tall temple spires, castle towers or Greek columns
- ☐ Made or licensed for this project; AI use noted; canon portraits flagged for advisory review